PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Toyota Land Cruiser 100 Series

1998–2007 · UZJ100 · FZJ105 · HZJ105 · HDJ100

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Ask for the timing-belt receipt**
  The 2UZ-FE uses a belt, and owners treat the 90,000-mile service (belt, water pump, thermostat, often idlers and seals) as essential. With no paperwork, assume it's due and price it in.
- [ ] **Know which front diff you're buying**
  Model-year 1998 and 1999 trucks have the two-pinion front differential that Wikipedia says fails most often under shock loads. The 2000 model year switched to a stronger four-pinion unit, but 1998–99 are also the only years with the optional rear locker.
- [ ] **Have the heater-hose tees been done?**
  The plastic tees in the heater hoses get brittle and can crack, dumping coolant. IH8MUD calls them part of the 90k service that most shops, Toyota dealers included, skip.
- [ ] **Listen at cold start**
  A tick or pop that sounds like an exhaust leak can be a spark plug working loose. IH8MUD's warning thread says to check the plugs before anything else, because a plug that blows out can take the cylinder-head threads with it.
- [ ] **Inspect the IFS**
  Look for cracks in the lower wishbones on trucks that have been driven hard enough to hit the bump stops, and check the lower ball joints and CV boots for play or splits.
- [ ] **Try a cold start more than once**
  Slee lists worn starter contacts as a known issue. The symptom is a click with no crank on the first try or two.
- [ ] **AHC trucks: check the ride height**
  On an LX 470, or one of the late Land Cruisers with AHC, make sure it levels itself and holds height. Ask when the AHC fluid was last flushed; owners on IH8MUD cite a 60,000-mile interval.
- [ ] **Do the body and wiring checks**
  Slee's inspection list applies here too: overspray, filler, frame-straightening marks, a rat's nest of accessory wiring under the dash, and fluids that look neglected. Cracked leather seats are common and costly to re-skin.

YEARS TO KNOW

1998–1999	BEWARE	Two-pinion front differential. It's the most common source of front-diff failures when the truck is driven hard
2003–2007	SWEET SPOT	Five-speed A750F automatic replaces the four-speed, with a no-contact throttle sensor; the late (2006–07) trucks add the VVT-i 2UZ-FE. These are the years owners most often point buyers to, and some say the five-speed matters more than the extra VVT-i power
2003–2006	RECALL	Model years covered by the side curtain airbag recall (16V065000)

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **Side curtain airbag inadvertent deployment**
  2003–2006 · NHTSA 16V065000
- ☐ **Missing load-capacity modification label**
  2005–2007 · NHTSA 09V223000 / 10V036000

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **100 vs 105**
  The 105 kept the 80 Series' solid front axle and straight-six engines and was sold in Africa, Australia, Russia and South America. Tells: the IFS 100 often sits nose-low, and 100s wear almost flat-faced wheels where 105s have dished ones.
- ☐ **Model codes**
  UZJ100 = 2UZ-FE 4.7 V8 (US). FZJ100/105 = 1FZ-FE 4.5 straight-six. HZJ105 = 1HZ diesel. HDJ100 = 1HD-T or 1HD-FTE turbo-diesel. Anything other than a UZJ100 in the US is an import.
- ☐ **Factory rear locker**
  The selectable rear locker was an option on 1998–1999 trucks only. A later truck with a rear locker has an aftermarket one.
- ☐ **Front diff**
  1998–1999 trucks (built mid-1997 to mid-1999) came with the weaker 2-pinion front diff; model year 2000 onward got the 4-pinion unit.
- ☐ **VIN**
  Toyota's own bulletins quote US UZJ100 VIN ranges beginning JT3HT05J. As on any US VIN, the 10th character is the model year (X = 1999, Y = 2000).

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/land-cruiser/100-series/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks